Q: Has your team or Twilio as an organisation contributed to external open source projects?

A: Twilio has individuals who contribute actively. For instance, we had team members on the Node.js advisory board. Through Twilio.org, employees are encouraged to use their skills to support non-profits and community initiatives, including through technical contributions. Twilio's open-source contributions happen largely through individuals doing their part rather than solely at an organizational level.

Q: You mentioned projects that Twilio has open sourced. Were those released recently, or have they been part of the ecosystem for a long time?

A: They have been part of the ecosystem for a long time. While Twilio's core backend is closed, the ecosystem layer is open, and we maintain a strong presence across GitHub through organisations like Twilio Labs. Twilio Labs publishes tools like the Twilio CLI, which acts as a wrapper around the API with additional plugin capabilities. Much of our effort goes into maintaining the open source developer tooling we provide. One of my favourite projects is Dev Phone, which gives developers a virtual phone number within their laptop setup to make and test calls locally when building voice applications.

Q: How do you see AI changing the mechanics of open source collaboration—both as automated code contributors and reviewers, and as tools to help maintainers manage codebases and large pull requests?

A: AI is already heavily active at the contributor and reviewer levels, but we're not at the point where an AI can act as a primary project maintainer.

Here is how it breaks down.

Contributors: Developers have been using AI to generate and refine code before submitting pull requests for years now, and the output quality keeps improving.

Reviewers: LLMs are fantastic for exploring large, unfamiliar codebases. Instead of struggling through massive changesets, reviewers can ask an LLM to explain the overarching pull request first before diving into specific files.

Maintainers: Right now, AI's best maintenance role is issue triaging—running initial checks on incoming bug reports and routing them to human maintainers. Relying on AI as a sole maintainer is too risky, and heavy API token usage gets expensive quickly.

Looking ahead, a promising trend is the rise of smaller, fine-tuned, task-specific language models. These run independently without high cloud token costs, making AI-assisted workflows accessible to all open source projects.

Q: Working closely with developers, how do you address the tool fatigue they face when trying out new tools constantly?

A: Tool fatigue comes directly from information overload and constantly chasing shiny new releases. Jumping to every new framework or model stops developers from building real domain depth—and sticking with a proven workflow doesn't make your approach outdated. The underlying model or tool is just the fuel; your guardrails, fundamentals, and engineering workflows are the actual engine. If your foundations are solid, any newer model will simply execute your work better.

I take a very structured, low-stakes approach: I experiment with new agentic workflows—like fanning out sub-agents for requirements gathering using Copilot or Claude Code—on personal hobby projects. But I would never deploy an unmonitored agentic system into a high-stakes production environment. My advice is simple: stop chasing every tool. Focus on your fundamentals and guardrails first, and let the tools adapt to your workflow.

Q: Is Twilio working on its own proprietary LLM, generative AI, or agentic model?

A: We don't build base LLMs—we build the infrastructure and data layers that power them. Others excel at training foundational models; our strength is global communications and enterprise context. With tools like our Conversations API, we take a 'Bring Your Own LLM' approach. We handle cross-channel messaging, real-time intelligence, and build a contextual customer memory data plane so callers don't have to repeat themselves. While we do run smaller, specialised internal models for tasks like fraud detection, our core role is serving as the global communications network for the AI era.

Q: From Twilio's perspective, how do open technologies and AI come together to change how developers build intelligent customer engagement experiences?

A: Writing code with an LLM is easy; deploying that AI reliably across real-time, multi-channel streams like voice, SMS, and web at scale is where the real complexity lives. While startups build intelligent AI models, they often struggle to tie them seamlessly into global communication networks with ultra-low latency. That's where Twilio's API infrastructure comes in. As a long-standing leader in the CPaaS space, we handle the scalability, routing, latency, and conversation state—allowing enterprises like ANA in Japan, major banks, and contact centres to run their own LLMs on top of our global communications network.